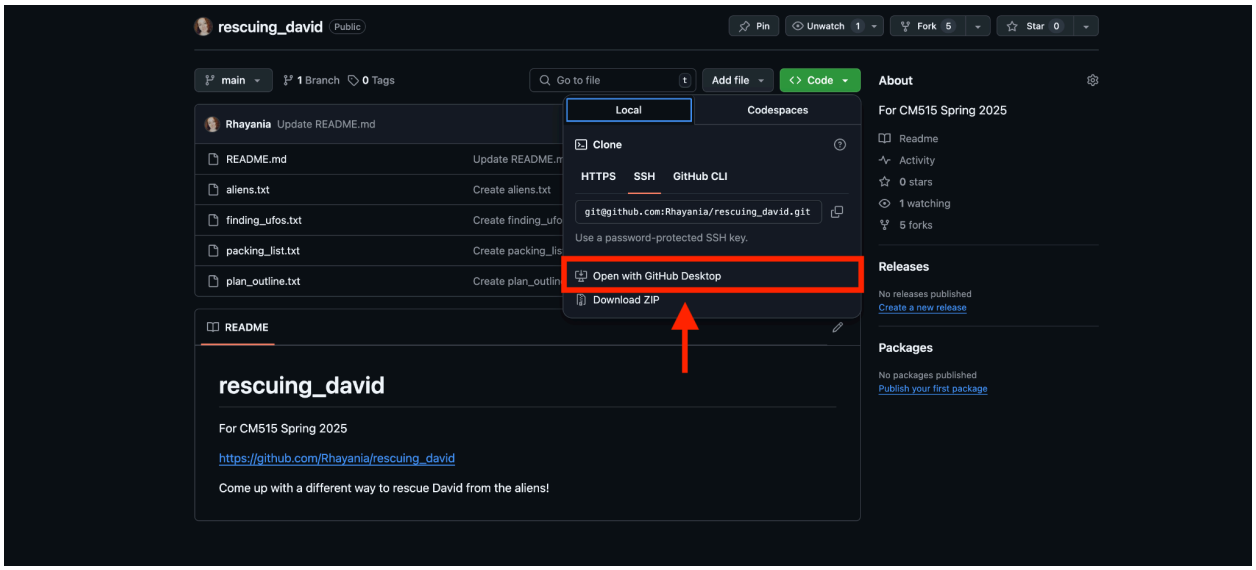
GitHub Basic Terms

Repository

A repository (or 'repo') is a storage space for your project, like a folder. It contains all of your project's files and the revision history of each file. Repositories can be hosted on GitHub.com and accessed or modified using GitHub Desktop, the command line, or other tools.

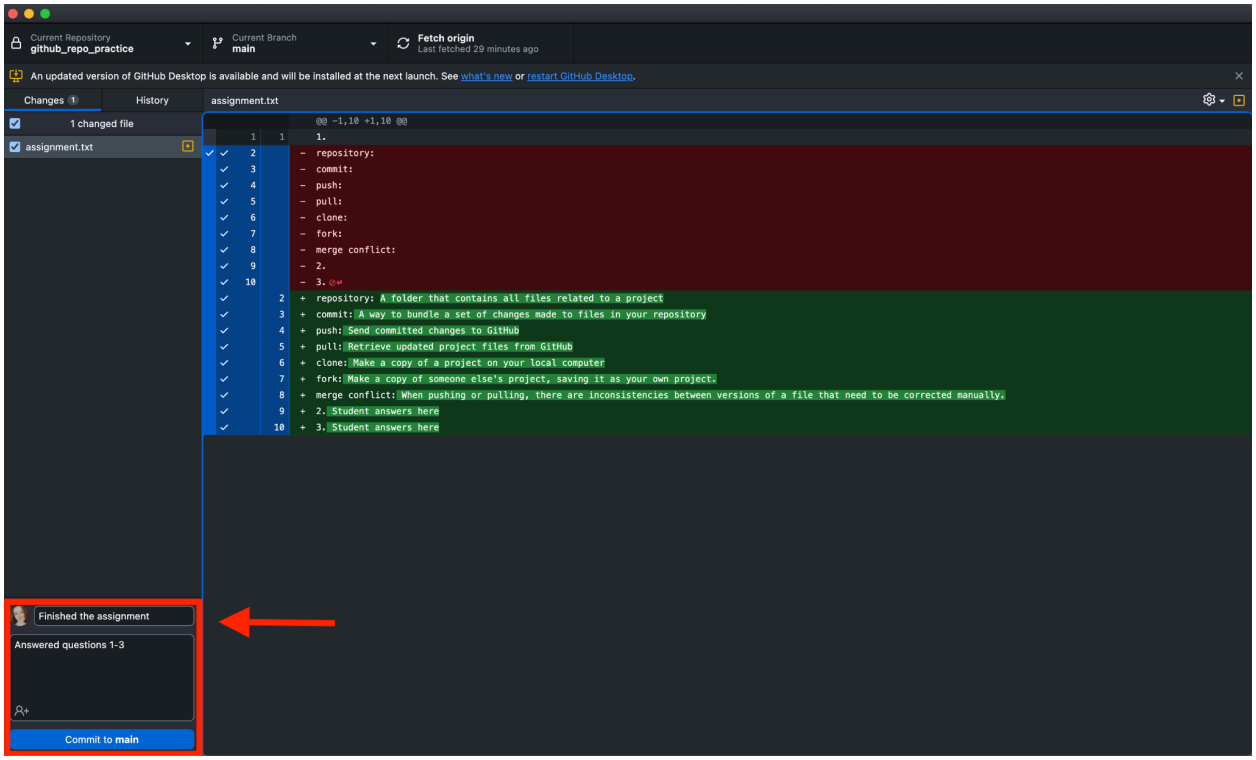
Clone

Cloning a repository means creating a local copy of it on your computer.



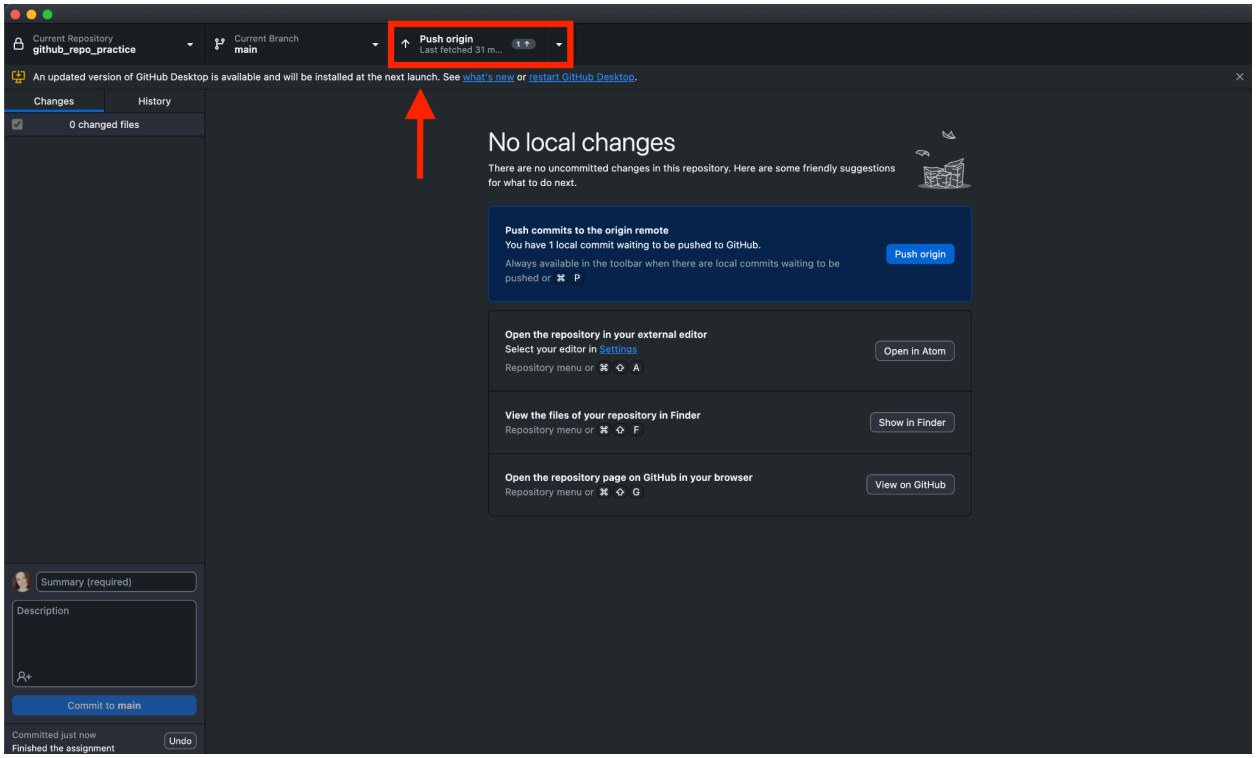
Commit

A commit is a snapshot of your changes. When you make changes to files in your repository, you 'commit' those changes to save them along with a message describing what you did. Your changes are still only on your local computer at this stage.



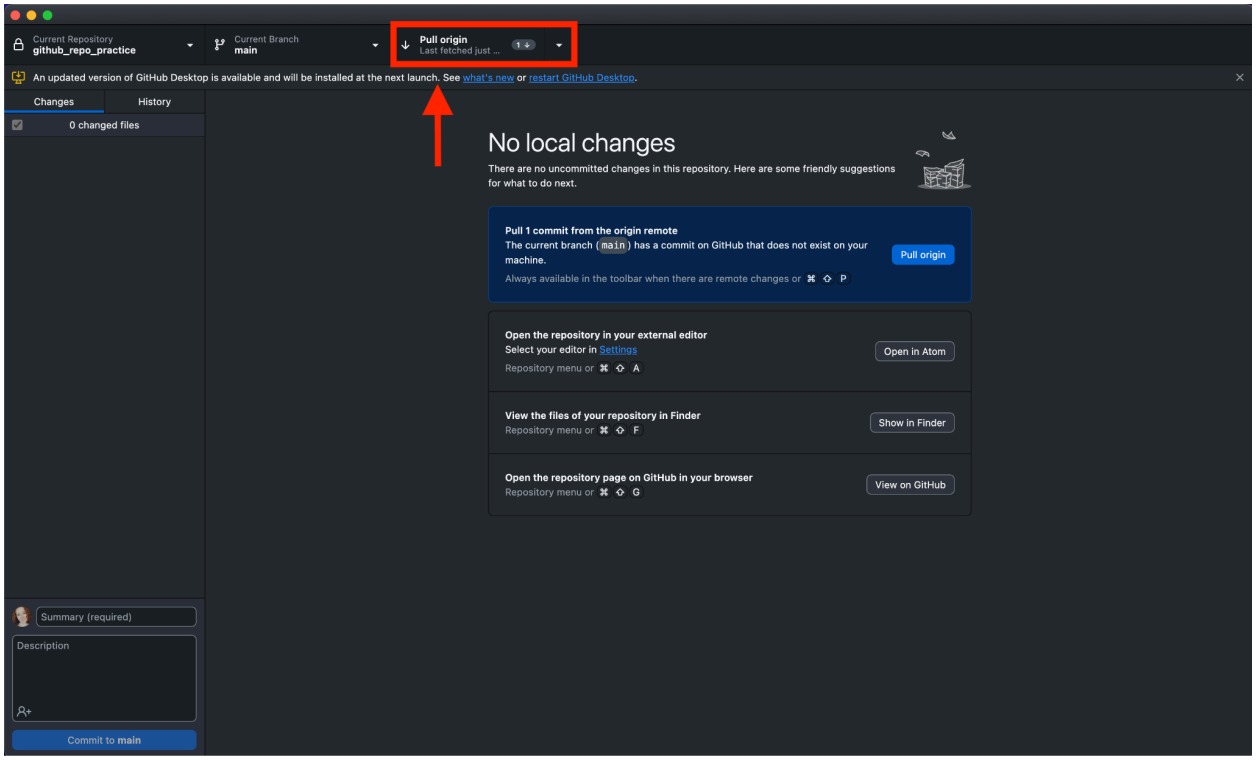
Push

Pushing sends your local commits to GitHub.com. In GitHub Desktop, you'll push your changes after committing them locally. After this step, you should be able to see the changes you pushed on GitHub.com.



Pull

Pulling fetches the latest changes from GitHub.com and updates your local copy. This ensures you're working with the most recent version of the project.

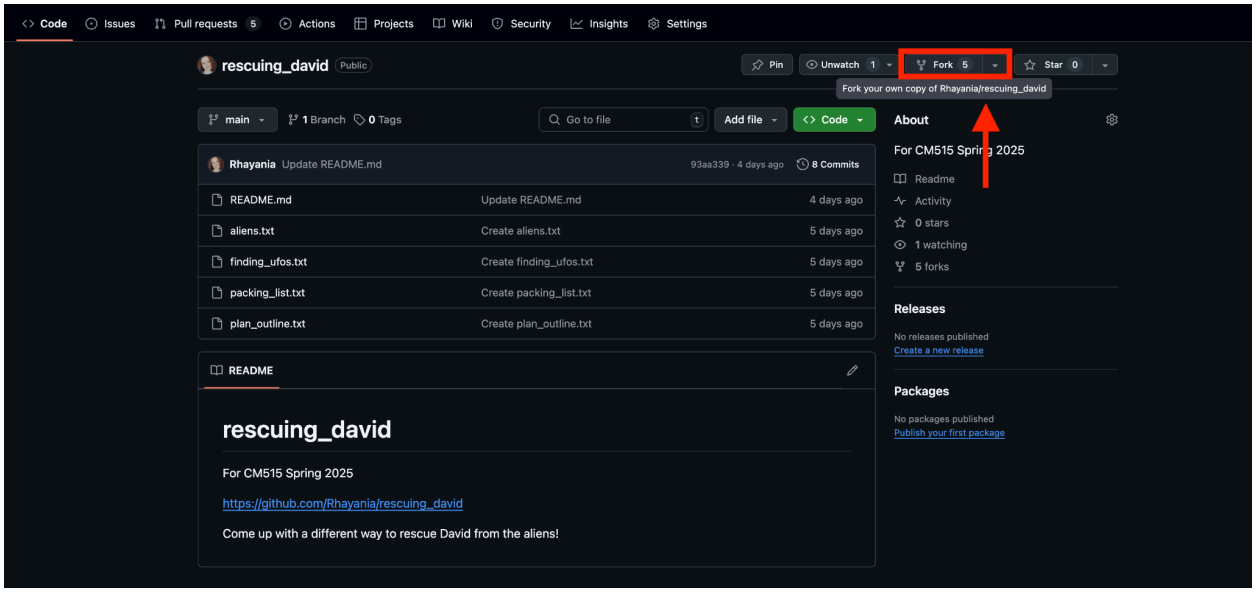


Merge Conflict

A merge conflict occurs when changes from different people conflict and GitHub can't automatically combine them. GitHub Desktop will alert you to the conflict and help you resolve it before you can complete the merge.

Fork

Forking is when you create your own copy of someone else's repository. You can make changes to your fork without affecting the original repository.



Pull Request

After making changes in your fork, you can open a pull request to propose merging your changes into the original repository. This is how contributions are reviewed and discussed before being added.

